Creator Requirements

Please review the following requirements before submitting your completed sound design. Submissions that do not meet these requirements will be rejected or returned for correction.

1. Required Files

Each submission must contain:

- **Video.mp4** — The original video with your completed sound design. Do not rename the provided video file
- **Mixdown.wav** — The final combined audio.
- **Individual WAV stems** — The exact separate audio tracks used to create the final mixdown.

Make sure all required files are included, correctly named, readable, and not corrupted. Do not include unnecessary or duplicate files.

2. Audio Format

The mixdown and every individual stem must meet the following specifications:

- WAV format.
- 48 kHz sample rate.
- 24-bit PCM.
- Stereo (2 channels).

Always check your export settings before rendering.

3. Mixdown Requirements

- The final mixdown should not exceed **–1 dBTP (True Peak)**.
- No digital clipping or distorted peaks.
- The audio must be complete and must not contain unintended silence.
- The mix must sound balanced, natural, and appropriate to the video.

4. Stem Requirements

- Provide at least **3 individual stems**.
- Each stem must contain its intended sound elements.
- No empty or silent stems.
- No duplicate stems.
- **Do not repeatedly paste the same sound recording** to artificially fill a track.
- All stems must have matching durations and start positions.
- Each stem must be correctly included in the final mixdown.

Important: When all individual stems are combined, they must reproduce the final `Mixdown.wav`. Do not change their volume or processing after creating the mixdown.

5. Video and Audio Synchronisation

- The audio in `Video.mp4` must match the submitted `Mixdown.wav`.
- All sound effects must be synchronised with the corresponding visual actions.
- **Do not** shift, shorten, or extend audio independently **after exporting the mixdown.**

6. Sound Quality and Content

- Include **only** the relevant sounds that are visibly or naturally implied by the scene.
- Make sure important actions are clearly audible.
- Use sounds appropriate to the materials, movements, and environment shown.
- **Avoid** unnecessary, repetitive, or unrelated sound effects.
- Maintain a believable acoustic perspective throughout the scene.

Use your professional judgement: if a sound is not audible or does not contribute to the scene, **it does not need to be added.** Quiet scenes can remain quiet.

7. Sound Descriptions

- Every stem must be listed correctly.
- Use clear, accurate descriptions of the sounds in each stem.
- Descriptions must reflect the actual audio, not just the visual action.

Example:

Good: "Footsteps of a person running on a concrete floor."

Bad: "person running."

Keep it short, clear, and accurate. The description must match the actual sound in the stem.

8. Final Check Before Uploading

Before submitting, make sure:

- ☐ All required files are included.
- ☐ All audio files are 48 kHz / 24-bit PCM / Stereo.
- ☐ Mixdown true peak does not exceed −1 dBTP.
- ☐ No clipping or unintended silence.
- ☐ At least 3 valid individual stems are included.
- ☐ No duplicate or repeated audio sections.
- ☐ All stems have matching duration and alignment.
- ☐ All stems together reproduce the mixdown.
- ☐ Video audio matches the mixdown.
- ☐ All sounds are synchronised with the video.
- ☐ Sound descriptions are complete and accurate.

Please check your exports carefully before uploading. The goal is to submit a complete, technically correct, and professionally finished sound design on the first attempt.